

San Francisco

The best of the best in the city — must-visit, unique, a rockstar in its own right. The first edition.

4

three-star
restaurants in the
city — Californios
new in 2026

26

Bib Gourmand
restaurants in
the Bay

1849

Tadich Grill
—
California's
oldest

799

places
across
twelve
lists

Honor Roll 10

Cafés 53

Speakeasies 50

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Scene 50

Nightlife 50

Itineraries 1 · 3 · 5 days

Yellow = you've been ★ Michelin star **Bib** Bib Gourmand (50 Best №1) bar ranking GS Michelin Green Star

JBF James Beard winner or nominee **closed** verify = check before you go

Resy Tock OpenTable SevenRooms where to book Amex ✓ Resy/Tock credit applies (Platinum \$100/qtr, Gold \$50 twice a year)

JBF 2026 James Beard nominee \$-\$\$\$\$ rough spend per person: under \$20 / \$20–60 / \$60–150 / \$150+

Romantic Date night Casual

occasion (editorial, by category and price)

Compiled by Tony Abraham against Yelp, Google, the San Francisco Chronicle, Eater SF, OpenTable, Resy, Tock and the Michelin Guide. Michelin marks reflect the 2026 California selection (June 2026), the most recent at time of printing; only stars, Green Stars and Bib Gourmands are shown. Cover: the Golden Gate at dusk, via Pexels.

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Technology entrepreneur. New Yorker. A passionate home cook who learned that the best way to understand a dish is to try to recreate it the next morning.

Honestly Speaking is written from a simple conviction: that the food itself — its taste, its texture, its quiet decisions — deserves a more careful kind of attention than it usually gets. The plate, not the room. The dish, not the hype.

Based in New York, with field notes from all around. *listedeville* / *San Francisco* is the sixth city guide — written the summer the first Mexican restaurant in the world earned three stars, in the city that gave America its burrito, its Irish coffee and its sourdough.

First edition, Fall/Winter 2026. Los Angeles and Seattle to follow.

Honestly Speaking is also a restaurant review site — independent, unsponsored, one dish at a time. The city guides tell you where; the reviews tell you what to order and why. Read them at honestlyspeaking.xyz.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listedeville.com.



Honor Roll • 10 plates

Don't leave without these.

Ten places, ranked by nothing but the plate. A focaccia counter that closes when it sells out, a marble oyster bar from 1912, a Mission burrito with a Bib and the first three-star Mexican restaurant on earth, all held to the same question: is this the best version of the thing in the city?

San Francisco has more three-star kitchens than any American city but New York and still eats best at counters. These ten are where the Guide, the Chronicle's critics and tens of thousands of Google reviews all point the same way, and where the food, not the view, is the reason. Room, scene and price didn't count.

How to read it The marks are the same as everywhere else in the guide. The two lines under each name are new: why it made the roll, and what to put in front of you when you get there.

Californios

01

Mission; Val Cantu — the world's first three-star Mexican restaurant

★★★ new 2026 promotion \$\$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Late night

Group

Val Cantu's tasting menu made history this year as the first Mexican restaurant anywhere to hold three stars, and it earns them on the plate: heirloom masa, California seafood, moles that take days. The one splurge on this roll that changes how you think about a cuisine.

Order The tasting, with the mezcal flight. The sope with caviar, the lobster aguachile and the quail in mole are the courses people remember.

State Bird Provisions

02

Fillmore

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night

Group

Dim-sum carts, but the carts carry Californian small plates — the format that made this the most-copied restaurant in the country a decade ago. Still a star, still a line for walk-ins before 5:30, and the namesake quail is still the reason.

Order The State Bird (fried quail with stewed onions), the sourdough-sauerkraut pancake with pecorino, the trout-dip potato chips, and whatever hand roll is on the cart.

San Ho Won

03

Mission; Korean grill, Corey Lee

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Corey Lee's Korean charcoal grill is Benu's casual sibling and, for most people, the better night: galbi over live coals, banchan made with the same care as his three-star kitchen, and a star at a third of the price.

Order The galbi and the pork jowl from the grill, the seafood pancake, and the naengmyeon to finish. Let them cook it.

Rintaro

04

Mission; izakaya

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Sylvan Mishima Brackett's izakaya in a hand-built Japanese room off Folsom Street: yakitori over binchotan, udon cut to order in front of you, a Bib every year since the guide arrived. The most beautiful room on this roll and the food keeps up.

Order The yakitori set, the katsu sando, the hand-cut udon (hot, in winter), and the oden if it's cold out. Reserve two weeks ahead.

Swan Oyster Depot

05

Nob Hill; since 1912; cash, counter

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Eighteen stools at a marble counter on Polk Street, open since 1912, cash only, closed by 2:30. The line is the price; the crab salad and the oysters shucked in front of you are the reward. There is no better lunch in the city.

Order A dozen oysters, the Dungeness crab salad, the smoked salmon and a bowl of chowder. Ask for the 'secret' sashimi plate. Get in line before 10:30.

La Taqueria

06

Mission; the burrito

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Mission burrito, from the counter that refuses to put rice in it: carne asada grilled to order, beans, salsa, a flour tortilla crisped on the plancha if you ask. Named the best burrito in America once, given a Bib since, and the line still moves.

Order Carne asada burrito, super, dorado (crisped). A carnitas taco on the side. Horchata.

Z & Y

07

Chinatown; Sichuan

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Chinatown's Sichuan standard-bearer: real ma-la heat, tea-smoked duck, a Bib on the door next to the photo of a presidential visit. Go with a table so you can order across the menu, and go hungry.

Order Chicken with explosive chili peppers, the tea-smoked duck, mapo tofu, and the fish fillets in flaming chili oil. Order 'medium' — it means hot.

Liguria Bakery

08

North Beach; focaccia, cash, until it's gone

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

One family, one product, since 1911: sheets of focaccia sold from a bare counter on Washington Square, wrapped in butcher paper, cash only, and gone by late morning. A 4.8 on Google and nothing to say except that it is the best bread in the city.

Order A sheet of the rosemary-garlic and a sheet of the pizza focaccia, cut to go. Be there by nine; when the racks are empty, the door locks.

Tartine Manufactory

09

Mission

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The bakery that changed how America thinks about bread, in its big Mission workshop with the ovens in view. The country loaf is the reason, but the morning bun, the croissants and the smørrebrød at lunch are why the line never shortens.

Order A morning bun and a croissant early, a country loaf to carry home, and the smoked-trout smørrebrød if it's lunch.

House of Prime Rib

10

Nob Hill; since 1949

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

One dish since 1949, carved tableside from a silver cart under a spinning salad bowl: prime rib, Yorkshire pudding, creamed spinach, mashed potatoes, and a second slice if you ask. It is the least fashionable restaurant in the city and one of the most loved for a reason.

Order The King Henry VIII cut, medium-rare, with the Yorkshire pudding and creamed spinach. Say yes to the second helping. Book weeks ahead.



Cafés · 53 places

Cafés & all-day / chef's neighborhood spots

Zuni's chicken, Nopa's bar, the Mission's Bibs, and the oyster counters that have been shucking since 1912.

San Francisco's neighborhood rooms are its best ones: Zuni since 1979, Nopa since 2006, and the Mission's Bibs — Flour + Water, Rintaro, the Morris, Piglet & Co. The oyster counters at Swan and Anchor are on for the ritual.

Why these Picked for the room you'd return to on a weeknight. Thirteen Bibs are on this list. Kitchen Istanbul is the 2026 addition; Good Good Culture Club is Liholiho reborn and back on the Bib list.

Nopa

Divisadero; since 2006

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Zuni Café

Market St; the roast chicken, since 1979

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Foreign Cinema

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Delfina

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Flour + Water

Mission

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Cotogna

Jackson Square

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Che Fico

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Rich Table

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Frances

Castro

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Rintaro

Mission; izakaya

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Morris

Mission; the duck

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Piccino

Dogpatch

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

La Ciccia

Noe Valley; Sardinian

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Trestle

Jackson Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Ernest

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Abacá

Fisherman's Wharf; Filipino

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bar Crenn

Cow Hollow

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Anchor Oyster Bar

Castro

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Swan Oyster Depot

Nob Hill; since 1912; cash, counter

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Hog Island Oyster Co.

Ferry Building

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tartine Manufactory

Mission

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Mill

Divisadero; Josey Baker bread

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Outerlands

Outer Sunset

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Palm City Wines

Outer Sunset; hoagies + wine

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Ungrafted

Dogpatch; wine bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Verjus?

closed ; use Bar Sprezzatura (FiDi; aperitivo) — ?

Kitchen Istanbul

Inner Richmond

Bib new 2026 Bib \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Good Good Culture Club

Mission; Liholiho's successor

Bib back in 2026 \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Copra

Fillmore; Kerala

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Pearl 6101

Outer Richmond

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Piglet & Co

Mission

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Prubechu

Mission; Chamorro

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Um.ma

Inner Sunset; Korean

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Snug

Pacific Heights

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Sotto Mare

North Beach; cioppino

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tony's Pizza Napoletana

North Beach

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Golden Boy Pizza

North Beach; focaccia squares

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Liguria Bakery

North Beach; focaccia, cash, until it's gone

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Molinari Delicatessen

North Beach; since 1896

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Mama's on Washington Square

North Beach; the line

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tommy's Joynt

Van Ness; hofbrau since 1947

\$ Walk-in

Casual

House of Prime Rib

Nob Hill; since 1949

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Tadich Grill

FiDi; since 1849

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Sam's Grill

FiDi; since 1867

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Boulevard

Embarcadero

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Kokkari Estiatorio

Jackson Square

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Perbacco

FiDi

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Park Tavern

North Beach

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Marlowe

SoMa

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Zazie

Cole Valley

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Plow

Potrero Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Brenda's French Soul Food

Tenderloin

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

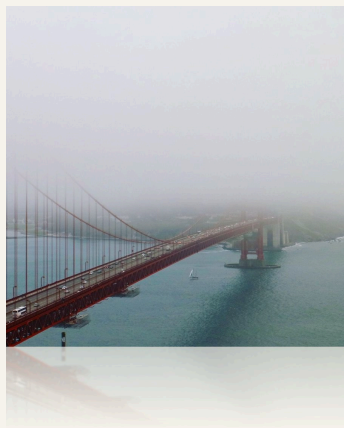
Date night Casual

Turntable at Lord Stanley

Russian Hill; visiting chefs

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual



Speakeasies · 50 places

Speakeasies & hidden bars

A password on Jones Street, a Tube station in the Tenderloin, a rainstorm in the Fairmont. Ranked, loosely, by the drink.

True Laurel and PCH lead on the drink; Bourbon & Branch and Whitechapel on the theater; the Tonga Room on the rainstorm. North Beach's Beat bars and Chinatown's Li Po are the history.

Why these Ranked by the drink. True Laurel (Nº17) and PCH (Nº16) held 2025 50 Best rankings. Bar Agricole, the Saratoga and Kona's are listed closed so you know what the scene lost.

True Laurel

Mission; Lazy Bear's bar

NA50 2025 #17 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Pacific Cocktail Haven

Union Square; "PCH"

NA50 2025 #16 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Trick Dog

Mission; the menu changes wholesale

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bourbon & Branch

Tenderloin; the password

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Wilson & Wilson

inside Bourbon & Branch

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Benjamin Cooper

Union Square; above the hotel

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Wildhawk

Mission

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

ABV

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Agricole

closed

Smuggler's Cove

Hayes Valley; three floors of rum

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Whitechapel

Tenderloin; gin, the Tube station

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Comstock Saloon

North Beach; 1907

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Tommy's Mexican Restaurant

Outer Richmond; the Tommy's margarita, Julio Bermejo

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Zam Zam

Haight; the martini, no talking at the bar

\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Tosca Café

North Beach; since 1919

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Vesuvio

North Beach; the Beats

\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Specs'

North Beach; the alley

\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Li Po Lounge

Chinatown; the Chinese mai tai

\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Buddha Lounge

Chinatown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Cold Drinks Bar

China Live; upstairs

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Moongate Lounge

above Mister Jiu's, Chinatown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Part Time

Mission; the record bar

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Key Klub

Tenderloin

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Dalva / Hideout

Mission; the back bar

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Elixir

Mission; since 1858

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Beehive

Mission

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Kona's Street Market

closed

The Saratoga

closed

Horsefeather

Divisadero

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Alembic

Haight

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Blackbird

Castro

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Novela

SoMa; the library bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Local Edition

FiDi; basement, the newspaper

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Rickhouse

FiDi; whiskey

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Hard Water

Embarcadero; bourbon

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Iris

Nob Hill; Japanese-Californian

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Dear Inga?

closed

Prizefighter

Emeryville; the drive

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Friends & Family

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Viridian

Oakland; Asian-American cocktails

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Shiru

Oakland; listening bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Kon-Tiki

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Forbidden Island

Alameda; tiki

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Tonga Room

Fairmont; the rainstorm

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Top of the Mark

InterContinental Mark Hopkins

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

The Buena Vista

Fisherman's Wharf; the Irish coffee, since 1952

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Big 4

Huntington Hotel; the piano

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Pied Piper Bar

Palace Hotel; the Maxfield Parrish

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Redwood Room

Clift; reopening

verify \$\$

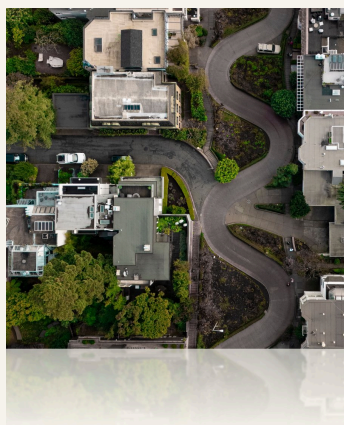
Date night Late night

Dogpatch Saloon

Dogpatch; since 1912

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night



Rooftops · 50 places

Rooftop bars

The bridge, the bay, the fog — and the piers and beer gardens that do the same job at water level.

A city of hills doesn't need many rooftops: Charmaine's, Everdene and El Techo are the real ones, and the piers, the Presidio and the beer gardens do the rest.

Why these Chosen for the view first, stretched to include the waterfront decks and Sausalito's, which are where locals would send you. Fog is the variable; the Mission and Dogpatch are sunnier than the Embarcadero.

Charmaine's

SF Proper, Mid-Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Everdene

Virgin Hotels, SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Kaiyo Rooftop

Mission Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

El Techo

Mission; above Lolinda

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Dirty Habit

Hotel Zelos, SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Jones

Tenderloin; the patio

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Top of the Mark

Nob Hill

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

View Lounge

Marriott Marquis; 39th floor

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Cityscape

Hilton Union Square; 46th floor

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Waterbar

Embarcadero; the bridge

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Epic Steak

Embarcadero

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Hard Water

Pier 3

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

La Mar Cebichería

Pier 1½; the pier

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Hog Island

Ferry Building; the back patio

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Angler

Embarcadero

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Coqueta

Pier 5

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Red's Java House

Pier 30; since 1923

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Pier 23 Cafe

Embarcadero; the deck

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Ramp

Dogpatch; on the water

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Mission Rock Resort

Mission Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Stem Kitchen & Garden

Mission Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

ATwater Tavern

Mission Bay; ballpark

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Presidio: Presidio Tunnel Tops

the picnic

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Presidio Social Club

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Sessions at the Presidio

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Greens

Fort Mason; the bridge view, vegetarian since 1979

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Fort Mason's Radhaus

beer hall

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Off the Grid

Fort Mason; Friday trucks, seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Cliff House

closed (reopening?) — ?

Beach Chalet

Ocean Beach

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Park Chalet garden

Golden Gate Park

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Outerlands' patio

Outer Sunset

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Woods Outbound

Outer Sunset; brewery patio

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Zeitgeist

Mission; the beer garden

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

El Rio

Mission; the patio

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Wild Side West

Bernal; the garden

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Biergarten

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Anina

Hayes Valley; patio

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Fort Point Valencia

Mission

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Cellarmaker House of Pizza

Bernal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Standard Deviant

Mission

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Harmonic Brewing

Dogpatch / Thrive City

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Barebottle

Bernal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Lake Chalet

Oakland; on Lake Merritt

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Drake's Dealership

Oakland; beer garden

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Sausalito: Bar Bocce

on the bay

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Sam's Anchor Cafe

Tiburon; the deck

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

The Trident

Sausalito

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Fish.

Sausalito; cash, the dock

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

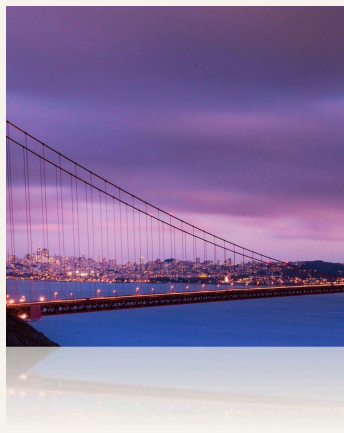
Date night Group

Rooftop at the Lodge at the Presidio

the bridge

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group



Bars · 114 places

Bars

Two on the 50 Best, the Tommy's margarita, the Beat bars of North Beach, and the dives since 1858.

A serious cocktail city since the 1990s — Julio Bermejo's margarita, the Bourbon & Branch era, Trick Dog's menus — with the oldest saloon in the city (1861) and the Beat bars still pouring.

Why these Ranked and recognized first, then institutions, hotel bars, dives, wine, beer. Toronado and Zeitgeist for the beer; Anchor Brewing is listed as a question because the revival keeps being announced.

Ranked & recognized

True Laurel

Mission

NA50 2025 #17 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Pacific Cocktail Haven

Union Square

NA50 2025 #16 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Trick Dog

Mission

JBF Outstanding Bar Program (past nominee)

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bourbon & Branch

Tenderloin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Smuggler's Cove

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Tommy's Mexican Restaurant

Outer Richmond

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Bar Iris

Nob Hill

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Cocktail institutions

Wildhawk

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

ABV

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Benjamin Cooper

Union Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Wilson & Wilson

Tenderloin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Whitechapel

Tenderloin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Comstock Saloon

North Beach

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Horsefeather

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Alembic

Haight

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Blackbird

Castro

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Novela

SoMa

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Local Edition

FiDi

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rickhouse

FiDi

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Hard Water

Embarcadero

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cold Drinks Bar

Chinatown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Moongate Lounge

Chinatown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Part Time

Mission

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Key Klub

Tenderloin

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Dalva

Mission

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Elixir

Mission

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Beehive

Mission

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Agricole

closed

The Saratoga

closed

Kona's Street Market

closed

Dear Inga

closed

15 Romolo

North Beach

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Devil's Acre

North Beach

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Trou Normand?

closed ; use Bar Crudo? — CLOSED; use Anchovy Bar (Fillmore)

Nightbird's Linden Room

Hayes Valley; 8 seats

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Brass Tacks

Hayes Valley

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Two Sisters Bar & Books

Hayes Valley

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Absinthe

Hayes Valley

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Bar Sprezzatura

FiDi

verify \$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Prizefighter

Emeryville

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Friends & Family

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Viridian

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Shiru

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Kon-Tiki

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Forbidden Island

Alameda

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Hotel & classic bars

Tonga Room

Fairmont

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Top of the Mark

Mark Hopkins

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Big 4

Huntington

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Pied Piper

Palace Hotel

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

The Buena Vista

Fisherman's Wharf

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Redwood Room

Clift

verify \$\$

Date night

Late night

Charmaine's

SF Proper

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Villon

SF Proper

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Everdene

Virgin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Dirty Habit

Zelos

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

The Battery

Jackson Square; members

\$\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Date night

Late night

Cafe Zoetrope

North Beach; Coppola's

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Historic / dive / neighborhood

Vesuvio

North Beach

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Specs'

North Beach

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Tosca Café

North Beach

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Li Po Lounge

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Buddha Lounge

Chinatown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Zam Zam

Haight

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Zeitgeist

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

El Rio

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Make-Out Room

Mission

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Homestead

Mission

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Phone Booth

Mission

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Doc's Clock

Mission

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Wild Side West

Bernal

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Riptide

Outer Sunset

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Trad'r Sam

Outer Richmond; tiki since 1937

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Saloon

North Beach; since 1861, blues

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Gino & Carlo

North Beach

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Aunt Charlie's Lounge

Tenderloin

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Twin Peaks Tavern

Castro; since 1972

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Stud

SoMa; reborn

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Hotel Utah Saloon

SoMa; since 1908

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

House of Shields

SoMa; since 1908

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Page

Lower Haight

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Toronado

Lower Haight

\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Wine bars

Ungrafted

Dogpatch

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Palm City Wines

Outer Sunset

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Verjus

closed

Bar Sprezzatura

FiDi

verify \$\$

Date night Late night

Nightbird's Linden Room

Hayes Valley

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Two Sisters

Hayes Valley

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Date night Late night

Fig & Thistle

Hayes Valley

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Ruby Wine

Potrero

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Yield Wine Bar

Dogpatch

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Press Club

SoMa

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Ordinaire

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Snail Bar

Oakland

[Bib](#) \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Bar Crenn

Cow Hollow

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Beer

Toronado

Lower Haight

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Zeitgeist

Mission

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Mikkeller Bar

Tenderloin

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Cellarmaker

SoMa / Bernal

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Fort Point

Presidio / Valencia / Ferry Building

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Standard Deviant

Mission

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Harmonic

Dogpatch

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Barebottle

Bernal

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Woods

Outer Sunset / Mission / Oakland

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Anchor Brewing

closed (revival?) — ?

Monk's Kettle

Mission

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Group Casual

Rosamunde Sausage Grill

Mission / Lower Haight

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Drake's Dealership

Oakland

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Temescal Brewing

Oakland

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Group Casual

Faction?

closed ; use Ghost Town Brewing (Oakland)

Rooftop / view bars that double as great bars

Charmaine's

SF Proper

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Everdene

Virgin

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

El Techo

Mission

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Late night

Top of the Mark

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Romantic Date night

Waterbar

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)



Coffee · 50 places

Coffee shops

Where third-wave coffee was invented, twice — and the bakeries that make the best cafés.

Ritual and Blue Bottle invented third-wave coffee here; Philz and Boba Guys were born in the Mission; Caffè Trieste pulled the West Coast's first espresso in 1956.

Why these Selected for the cup and the room. The bakeries that double as cafés — Tartine, the Mill, Arsicault — are the best mornings in the city.

Ritual Coffee Roasters

Mission / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sightglass

SoMa / Mission / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Saint Frank

Russian Hill / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Andytown Coffee Roasters

Outer Sunset; the Snowy Plover

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Wrecking Ball Coffee

Cow Hollow

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Blue Bottle

born Oakland; Ferry Building / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Philz Coffee

born Mission; multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Four Barrel Coffee

Mission

verify \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

The Mill

Divisadero; Four Barrel + Josey Baker

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hollow

Inner Sunset

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Trouble Coffee

Outer Sunset; cinnamon toast

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Java Beach

Outer Sunset

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Flywheel

Cole Valley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Grand Coffee

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Linea Caffe

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Coffee Movement

Nob Hill / Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Caffè Trieste

North Beach; since 1956; the first espresso west of the Mississippi

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Caffe Greco

North Beach

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Réveille

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Equator

Fort Mason / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Verve

Castro / multiple; Santa Cruz import

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tartine

Guerrero St; the line

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Arsicault

Inner Richmond; the croissant

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

B. Patisserie

Pacific Heights; kouign amann

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Jane the Bakery

Fillmore / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Neighbor Bakehouse

Dogpatch

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Craftsman & Wolves

Mission; the Rebel Within

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Boba Guys

born Mission; multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Stonemill Matcha

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Samovar Tea

Mission / Yerba Buena

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Red Blossom Tea

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Vital Tea Leaf

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Golden Gate Fortune Cookie Factory

Chinatown; the alley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Yasukochi's Sweet Stop

Japantown; coffee crunch cake

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bob's Donuts

Nob Hill; 24 hours

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dynamo Donut

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

~~Mr. Holmes Bakehouse~~

closed

Devil's Teeth Baking Company

Outer Sunset; the breakfast sandwich

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Kahnfections

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Loquat

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Le Marais Bakery

Marina / Castro

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

La Boulangerie de San Francisco

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Noe Valley Bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Destination Baking Company

Glen Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Arizmendi

Inner Sunset / Mission; the co-op

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cheese Board Collective

Berkeley; the drive

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Acme Bread

Ferry Building / Berkeley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Boichik Bagels

Berkeley / SF; the NYT's best bagel

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Wise Sons

Mission / Ferry Building

\$ Walk-in

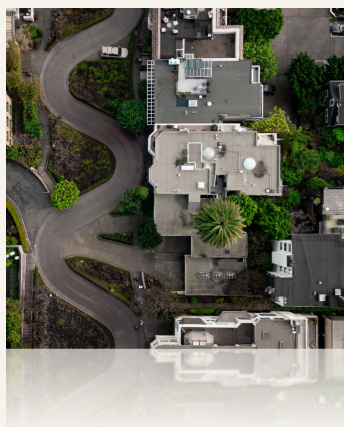
Sweets Brunch

Daily Driver

Dogpatch; bagels + butter

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Restaurants · 182 places

Restaurants

Four three-stars in the city, six with the Wine Country, a Bib bench deep in the Mission, and the Chinatown, Tenderloin and Richmond kitchens that are the actual city.

The 2026 California selection made Californios the first three-star Mexican restaurant in the world, joining Atelier Crenn, Benu and Quince; Enclos joined the French Laundry and SingleThread at three in Wine Country. Around them: the Mission's Bibs, Chinatown's institutions, and the Tenderloin's Vietnamese counters.

Why these Grouped by distinction, then Wine Country and the coast, then the Bibs, then the classics. Tock and Resy split the counters. The Progress and Kin Khao are flagged; both changed shape since the last guide.

Michelin ★★★

Californios

Mission; Val Cantu — the world's first three-star Mexican restaurant

★★★ new 2026 promotion \$\$\$\$

Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Atelier Crenn

Cow Hollow; Dominique Crenn

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Benu

SoMa; Corey Lee

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Quince

Jackson Square; Michael Tusk

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Michelin ★★

Kiln

SoMa

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Lazy Bear

Mission; the dinner party

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Saison

SoMa; the hearth

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Acquerello

Nob Hill; since 1989

★★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Birdsong

SoMa

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Commis

Oakland; James Syhabout

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Michelin ★

7 Adams

Laurel Heights

★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night

Sorrel

Pacific Heights

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Nari

Japantown; Pim Techamuanvivit

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Mister Jiu's

Chinatown; Brandon Jew

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

State Bird Provisions

Fillmore

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

The Progress

Fillmore

verify \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Nisei

Russian Hill; David Yoshimura

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Ju-Ni

Western Addition; omakase

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Omakase

SoMa

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Shota

FiDi; omakase

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Marlena

Bernal Heights

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Nightbird

Hayes Valley; Kim Alter

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Osito

Mission; live fire

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

San Ho Won

Mission; Korean grill, Corey Lee

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Sons & Daughters

Nob Hill

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

SPQR

Fillmore

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Spruce

Presidio Heights

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Ssai

Russian Hill; Korean tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Anomaly

Pacific Heights

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Restaurant Naides

★ new 2026 star \$\$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Wolfsbane

San Francisco

★ new 2026 star \$\$\$\$

Romantic Date night

Aphotic

closed

Sushi Yoshizumi

San Mateo

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Angler

Embarcadero

no longer starred; still essential \$\$\$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Gary Danko

Russian Hill

no longer starred; still essential \$\$\$\$

OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Kin Khao

closed (reopened as Nari's sibling?) — ?

Worth the drive (Wine Country & the coast)

The French Laundry

Yountville; Thomas Keller

★★★★ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

SingleThread

Healdsburg

★★★★ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Enclos

Sonoma

★★★★ new 2026 promotion \$\$\$\$

Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Cyrus

Geyserville

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Auberge du Soleil

Rutherford

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Press

St. Helena

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Auro

Calistoga

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Troubadour Bread & Bistro

Healdsburg; the bread counter

★ new 2026 star \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Kenzo

Napa

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

La Calenda

Yountville; Keller's Mexican

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bouchon

Yountville

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Ad Hoc

Yountville; fried chicken Mondays

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Chez Panisse

Berkeley; Alice Waters, since 1971

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night Group

Aubergine

Carmel

★★ \$\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sierra Mar

Big Sur; Post Ranch

GS \$\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bib Gourmand (2026)

Kitchen Istanbul

Inner Richmond

Bib new 2026 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Good Good Culture Club

Mission

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Ippuku

Berkeley; izakaya

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Joodooboo

Oakland; tofu

Bib new 2026 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Flour + Water

Mission

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Cotogna

Jackson Square

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Rintaro

Mission

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

The Morris

Mission

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Anchor Oyster Bar

Castro

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Copra

Fillmore

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Pearl 6101

Outer Richmond

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Piglet & Co

Mission

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Prubechu

Mission

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Um.ma

Inner Sunset

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

La Taqueria

Mission; the burrito

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Z & Y

Chinatown; Sichuan

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Hong Kong Lounge II

Inner Richmond; dim sum

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Dumpling Home

Hayes Valley

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Lers Ros

Tenderloin / Hayes Valley; Thai

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bini's Kitchen

SoMa; Nepalese momos

Bib \$ Walk-in

Casual

4505 Burgers & BBQ

Divisadero

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

A16

Marina

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Del Popolo

Nob Hill; pizza

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

El Buen Comer

Bernal; Mexican

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Chapeau!

Inner Richmond; French

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Insalata's

San Anselmo

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Snail Bar

Oakland

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Burdell

Oakland; Geoff Davis

JBF 2025 Best New Restaurant finalist

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Nyum Bai

Oakland; Cambodian

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Daytrip

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Friends & Family

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Pomet

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

FOB Kitchen

Oakland; Filipino

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

The new guard

Bar Iris

Nob Hill

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Turntable at Lord Stanley

Russian Hill

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Abacá

Fisherman's Wharf

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Ernest

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Bar Crenn

Cow Hollow

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Merchant Roots

Fillmore; themed tasting

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Mourad

SoMa; Moroccan

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

The Anchovy Bar

Fillmore

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Empress by Boon

Chinatown; the room

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night Group

Four Kings

Chinatown; Cantonese, Mister Jiu's alumni

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Lion Dance Cafe?

closed ; use Bansang (Fillmore; Korean) — NEW

Dalida

Presidio; Eastern Mediterranean

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bar Sprezzatura

FiDi

verify \$\$

Casual Date night

Ok's Deli

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Radhaus

Fort Mason

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Classics & must-visits

Zuni Café

Market St

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Nopa

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Delfina

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Foreign Cinema

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Che Fico

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Rich Table

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Frances

Castro

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Boulevard

Embarcadero

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Kokkari

Jackson Square

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Perbacco

FiDi

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Tadich Grill

FiDi

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Sam's Grill

FiDi

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Date night

House of Prime Rib

Nob Hill

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Date night

Swan Oyster Depot

Nob Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Hog Island Oyster Co.

Ferry Building

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Waterbar

Embarcadero

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Romantic Date night

Angler

Embarcadero

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Gary Danko

Russian Hill

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Romantic Date night

La Mar Cebichería

Embarcadero

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Coqueta

Pier 5; Michael Chiarello's

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Yank Sing

SoMa; dim sum

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Good Mong Kok Bakery

Chinatown; dim sum to go

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

R&G Lounge

Chinatown; salt and pepper crab

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Great Eastern

Chinatown; Obama's stop

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

China Live

Chinatown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Burma Superstar

Inner Richmond

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Mandalay

Inner Richmond

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Turtle Tower

Tenderloin; pho

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Saigon Sandwich

Tenderloin; bánh mì, cash

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Bodega SF

Tenderloin; Vietnamese

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Brenda's

Tenderloin

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

~~Liholiho Yacht Club~~

closed (see [Good Good Culture Club](#))

Mission Chinese Food

closed

Al's Place

closed

El Farolito

Mission; the burrito

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

La Taqueria

Mission

[Bib](#) \$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual

Taqueria Cancún

Mission

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Papalote

Mission; the salsa

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Tacolicious

multiple

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Limón Rotisserie

Mission; Peruvian

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Lolinda

Mission; Argentine

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Beretta

Mission

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Tony's Pizza Napoletana

North Beach

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Golden Boy

North Beach

\$\$

Casual Date night

Il Casaro

North Beach

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Sotto Mare

North Beach

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Original Joe's

North Beach; since 1937

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Tommy's Joynt

Van Ness

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Greens

Fort Mason

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Nopalito

Inner Sunset / Panhandle

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Outerlands

Outer Sunset

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Hook Fish Co

Outer Sunset

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Marnee Thai

Inner Sunset

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

San Tung

Inner Sunset; dry-fried chicken wings

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Wako

Inner Richmond; sushi

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Ijji

Hayes Valley; omakase

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic [Date night](#)

Kusakabe

FiDi; omakase

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic [Date night](#)

Akiko's

Union Square

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic [Date night](#)

Hashiri

closed

Ebisu

Inner Sunset; since 1981

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Rooh

SoMa; Indian

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Besharam

Dogpatch; Gujarati

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Dosa?

closed ; use [Udupi Palace \(Mission\)](#)

Piccino

Dogpatch

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Serpentine?

closed ; use [Just for You Cafe \(Dogpatch\)](#)

Chez Panisse

Berkeley

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Cheese Board Pizza

Berkeley

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual [Group](#)

Great China

Berkeley; Peking duck

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Vik's Chaat

Berkeley

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Wood Tavern

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Champa Garden

Oakland; Lao

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Tacos Oscar

Oakland

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Horn Barbecue

closed

Smokin Woods BBQ

Oakland

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Marufuku Ramen

Japantown / multiple

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Mensho Tokyo

Tenderloin

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Sushi Ran

Sausalito

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#)

Fish.

Sausalito

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Sam's Anchor Cafe

Tiburon

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Duarte's Tavern

Pescadero; artichoke soup

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Hog Island Oyster Farm

Marshall; the drive to Tomales Bay

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Nick's Cove

Marshall

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

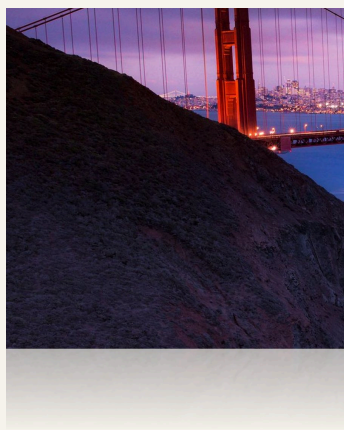
Casual Date night

The Marshall Store

Tomales Bay

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night



Brunch · 51 places

Brunch spots

Zazie's garden, Plow's potatoes, beignets in the Tenderloin, and Saturday at the Ferry Building.

Sunday means Zazie's garden, Plow's potatoes, beignets at Brenda's, and the Ferry Building on Saturday morning. The bakeries do the rest.

Why these Kept to places that consistently top Resy and OpenTable's weekend demand plus the counters you walk into. Mama's line on Washington Square is a civic institution.

Zazie

Cole Valley; the garden

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Plow

Potrero Hill; the potatoes

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Brenda's French Soul Food

Tenderloin; beignets

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Foreign Cinema

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Nopa brunch

Divisadero

\$\$

Brunch

Outerlands

Outer Sunset

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Tartine Manufactory

Mission

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Tartine Bakery

Guerrero; the morning bun

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Kitchen Story

Castro

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Sweet Maple

Pacific Heights; millionaire's bacon

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Mama's on Washington Square

North Beach

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Dottie's True Blue Café

SoMa

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Rose's Café

Cow Hollow

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Universal Café

Potrero Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Boulettes Larder

Ferry Building

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Hog Island

Ferry Building; the oyster breakfast

\$\$

Brunch

Ferry Building Saturday Market

the stalls

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Chloe's Café

Noe Valley

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Devil's Teeth

Outer Sunset

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Trouble Coffee

Outer Sunset

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Andytown

Outer Sunset

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Wise Sons

Mission / Ferry Building

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Boichik Bagels

Berkeley / SF

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Daily Driver

Dogpatch

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

The Mill

Divisadero; toast

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Arsicault

Inner Richmond

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

B. Patisserie

Pacific Heights

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Jane the Bakery

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Craftsman & Wolves

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Neighbor Bakehouse

Dogpatch

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

St. Francis Fountain

Mission; since 1918

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Boogaloos

Mission

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Beretta brunch

Mission

\$\$

Brunch

Sunday at El Techo

Mission

\$\$

Brunch

Piccino

Dogpatch

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Just for You Cafe

Dogpatch

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Park Tavern brunch

North Beach

\$\$

Brunch

Marlowe brunch

SoMa

\$\$

Brunch

The Buena Vista

Fisherman's Wharf; Irish coffee breakfast

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Greens

Fort Mason; Sunday

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Presidio Social Club

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Beach Chalet

Ocean Beach

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Yank Sing

dim sum

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Hong Kong Lounge II

dim sum

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Good Mong Kok

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Sam's Anchor Cafe

Tiburon

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Fish.

Sausalito

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Cheese Board

Berkeley

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Bette's Oceanview Diner

closed ; use La Note (Berkeley; French)

Grand Lake Kitchen

Oakland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Brown Sugar Kitchen

Oakland; the waffle

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch



Off-beat · 50 places

Off-beat & only-in-San Francisco

Cash at Swan, focaccia at Liguria, the burrito war on Mission Street, and an indoor rainstorm.

Cash at Swan Oyster Depot since 1912, focaccia at Liguria until it runs out, the burrito war between El Farolito and La Taqueria, the Irish coffee that was invented at the Buena Vista, and an indoor rainstorm at the Fairmont.

Why these Selected for singularity. Californios is here as well as under the stars because a three-star Mexican restaurant in the Mission is the most San Francisco thing on the list.

Swan Oyster Depot

Nob Hill; the counter, cash, 1912

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

The Buena Vista

the Irish coffee, invented here 1952

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Tonga Room

Fairmont; the indoor rainstorm

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

House of Prime Rib

the silver cart

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

Tadich Grill

the oldest restaurant in California

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

Sam's Grill

the curtained booths

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

Tommy's Joynt

the hofbrau line

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Tommy's Mexican

the margarita, Outer Richmond

\$

Casual

Zam Zam

the martini, the rules

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Liguria Bakery

focaccia, cash, gone by noon

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Golden Boy Pizza

the focaccia square

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Molinari

the sandwich, 1896

\$

Casual

Mama's

the line on Washington Square

\$

Casual

Caffè Trieste

the first espresso on the West Coast

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Vesuvio / City Lights

the Beats

\$

Casual

Golden Gate Fortune Cookie Factory

Ross Alley

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Good Mong Kok

the dim sum window

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Li Po

the Chinese mai tai

\$

Casual

Sam Wo

Chinatown; since 1907

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Mr. Bing's

dice at the bar

\$ Walk-in

Casual

El Farolito vs La Taqueria

the burrito war

\$

Casual

Papalote

the salsa

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Dynamo Donut

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bob's Donuts

Nob Hill; 3am

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bi-Rite Creamery

Mission; the line on 18th

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Mitchell's Ice Cream

Bernal; since 1953; ube, mango

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Humphry Slocombe

Mission; Secret Breakfast

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Swensen's

Russian Hill; the original, 1948

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ghirardelli

the square; the sundae

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Boudin

Fisherman's Wharf; the bread bowl, since 1849

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Red's Java House

Pier 30; the burger on the pier

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Pier 23 Cafe

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Alemanys Farmers' Market

Saturday; the oldest in the state

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ferry Building Saturday Market

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Off the Grid

Fort Mason Fridays

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hog Island Oyster Farm

Marshall; shuck your own

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Duarte's

Pescadero; artichoke soup

\$

Casual

Sushi Ran

Sausalito

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Fish.

Sausalito; cash, on the dock

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Sam's

Tiburon; the deck, the ferry

\$

Casual

Cheese Board

Berkeley; one pizza a day

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Chez Panisse Café

Berkeley; upstairs, no tasting menu

\$

Casual

Vik's Chaat

Berkeley

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ippuku

Berkeley; the tavern

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Saigon Sandwich

Tenderloin; \$5, cash

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Turtle Tower

Tenderloin

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Brenda's

Tenderloin

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Bini's Kitchen

momos from a kiosk

Bib \$ Walk-in

Casual

Anchor Oyster Bar

Castro; 1977

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Californios

the first three-star Mexican restaurant in the world

★ ★ ★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual



Bakeries · 49 places

Bakeries

Tartine's morning bun, Arsicault's croissant, and the sourdough the city is named for.

Tartine's morning bun, Arsicault's croissant, B. Patisserie's kouign amann, Josey Baker's bread, and the sourdough Boudin has made since 1849. Troubadour's bread counter in Healdsburg now has a star.

Why these Chosen on the strength of one signature item each. Liguria and Eastern Bakery are on for a century each; Boichik for the bagel the New York Times called the best in the country.

Tartine Bakery

Mission; the morning bun

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tartine Manufactory

Mission

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Arsicault

Inner Richmond / Civic Center; the croissant

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

B. Patisserie

Pacific Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

The Mill / Josey Baker Bread

Divisadero

\$

Sweets Brunch

Jane the Bakery

Fillmore

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Neighbor Bakehouse

Dogpatch

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Craftsman & Wolves

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Liguria Bakery

North Beach

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Acme Bread

Ferry Building

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Boudin

Fisherman's Wharf

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Arizmendi

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cheese Board Collective

Berkeley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

La Boulangerie de SF

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Le Marais

Marina / Castro

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Noe Valley Bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Destination Baking

Glen Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Devil's Teeth

Outer Sunset

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Kahnfections

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Loquat

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Mr. Holmes

closed

Bob's Donuts

Nob Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dynamo Donut

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Yasukochi's Sweet Stop

Japantown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Golden Gate Fortune Cookie

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Good Mong Kok

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

AA Bakery & Cafe

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Eastern Bakery

Chinatown; since 1924; mooncakes

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Stella Pastry

North Beach; sacripantina

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Victoria Pastry

North Beach; since 1914

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dianda's

Mission; Italian-American, since 1962

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

La Victoria

Mission; pan dulce

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

La Reyna

Mission; pan dulce

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Pastelería?

\$

Sweets Brunch

Cinderella Bakery

Inner Richmond; Russian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Boichik Bagels

Berkeley / SF

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Wise Sons

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Daily Driver

Dogpatch

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Marla Bakery

Outer Richmond

verify \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Thorough Bread and Pastry

Castro

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Black Jet Baking Co.

Bernal

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Vive La Tarte?

closed ; use Mission Pie — CLOSED; use Pie: Three Babes Bakeshop (Bayview / Ferry Building)

Pinkie's Bakery

SoMa

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Rize Up Bakery

Mission; sourdough

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Grand Bakery?

closed ; use Starter Bakery (Oakland)

Firebrand

Oakland

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Semifreddi's

Berkeley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sweet Adeline

Berkeley

\$ Walk-in

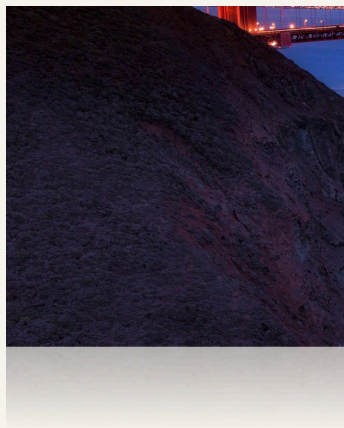
Sweets Brunch

Bakesale Betty

Oakland; the fried chicken sandwich

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Dessert • 50 places

Dessert bars & sweets

For after — or instead of — dinner.

Bi-Rite's line, Mitchell's ube, Humphry Slocombe's Secret Breakfast, Dandelion's chocolate factory, and See's, born here in 1921.

Why these A mix of the destination and the institution. The three-star finales are here because in this city they're worth planning a night around.

Bi-Rite Creamery

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Humphry Slocombe

Mission / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mitchell's Ice Cream

Bernal

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Swensen's

Russian Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Salt & Straw

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Smitten

multiple; liquid nitrogen

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Garden Creamery

Mission; Hawaiian-Japanese

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Marco Polo Italian Ice Cream

Inner Sunset; Asian flavors

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Polly Ann Ice Cream

Outer Sunset; the wheel

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Ghirardelli

the square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Dandelion Chocolate

Mission; the factory

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Recchiuti Confections

Ferry Building

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

XOX Truffles

North Beach

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

See's Candies

born SF, 1921; multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Yasukochi's coffee crunch cake

Japantown

\$

Sweets

Stella's sacripantina

North Beach

\$

Sweets

Victoria's St. Honoré

North Beach

\$

Sweets

Tartine's morning bun

\$

Sweets

B. Patisserie's kouign amann

\$

Sweets

Arsicault's croissant

\$

Sweets

Craftsman & Wolves' Rebel Within

\$

Sweets

Dynamo's maple bacon

\$

Sweets

Bob's apple fritter

\$

Sweets

Devil's Teeth's cinnamon roll

\$

Sweets

Boba Guys

multiple

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Stonemill Matcha

Mission

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Teaspoon?

\$

Sweets

Mochi: Benkyodo

closed (2022); use Nippon-Ya (Japantown; mochi)

Belly Good Café

Japantown; cat crêpes

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Golden Gate Fortune Cookie

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Eastern Bakery

mooncakes

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

AA Bakery

egg tarts

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Golden Gate Bakery

Chinatown; egg tarts, when open

verify \$

Walk-in

Sweets

Dianda's

Mission

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

La Victoria

pan dulce

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Nightbird's dessert course

Hayes Valley

★ \$\$\$

Sweets

Atelier Crenn's dessert

Cow Hollow

★ ★ ★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Californios' dessert

Mission

★ ★ ★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Lazy Bear's finale

Mission

★ ★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Benu's finale

SoMa

★ ★ ★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Quince

Jackson Square

★ ★ ★ \$\$\$\$

Tock

Amex ✓

Sweets

Sons & Daughters' dessert

Nob Hill

★ \$\$\$

Sweets

Caffè Trieste's cannoli

\$

Sweets

The Buena Vista's Irish coffee

dessert, arguably

\$

Sweets

Three Babes Bakeshop

pie

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Black Jet

Bernal

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Bakesale Betty

Oakland

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Hot Cookie

Castro

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

Anthony's Cookies

Mission

\$

Walk-in

Sweets

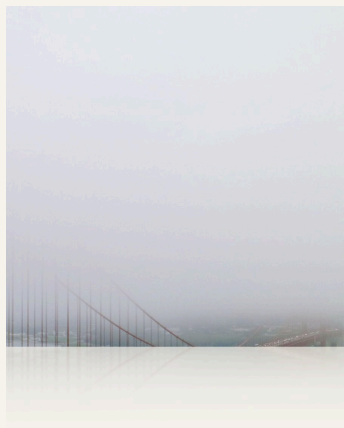
Fentons Creamery

Oakland; since 1894

\$

Walk-in

Sweets



Scene · 50 places

Notable mentions

Where the room is the point: Jackson Square, the Embarcadero, Nob Hill's hotel bars, and the counters where the tasting is theater.

Where the room is the point: Empress by Boon's Chinatown ballroom, the Embarcadero's bridge views, Nob Hill's hotel bars, and the counters where the tasting is theater.

Why these Jackson Square and the Embarcadero lead; the tasting rooms are here for the show as much as the food. The Battery is on because everyone will ask.

Empress by Boon

Chinatown; the room

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Mister Jiu's

Chinatown

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Moongate Lounge

Chinatown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

China Live

Chinatown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Kokkari

Jackson Square

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Quince

Jackson Square

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Cotogna

Jackson Square

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Battery

Jackson Square; members

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Romantic Group

Wayfare Tavern

FiDi

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Tadich Grill

FiDi

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Boulevard

Embarcadero

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Waterbar

Embarcadero

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Epic Steak

Embarcadero

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Angler

Embarcadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

La Mar

Embarcadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Coqueta

Pier 5

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Gary Danko

Russian Hill

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Acquerello

Nob Hill

★★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

House of Prime Rib

Nob Hill

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Sons & Daughters

Nob Hill

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Top of the Mark

Nob Hill

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Tonga Room

Nob Hill

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Big 4

Nob Hill

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Spruce

Presidio Heights

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Atelier Crenn

Cow Hollow

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Bar Crenn

Cow Hollow

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

A16

Marina

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Benu

SoMa

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Saison

SoMa

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Birdsong

SoMa

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Kiln

SoMa

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Mourad

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Marlowe

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Californios

Mission

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Lazy Bear

Mission

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Foreign Cinema

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Osito

Mission

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Nopa

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Che Fico

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

State Bird / The Progress

Fillmore

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Nari

Japantown

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Nightbird

Hayes Valley

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Absinthe

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Zuni Café

Market St

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Charmaine's

SF Proper

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Villon

SF Proper

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Buena Vista

Fisherman's Wharf

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Sam's Anchor Cafe

Tiburon

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

The French Laundry

Yountville

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

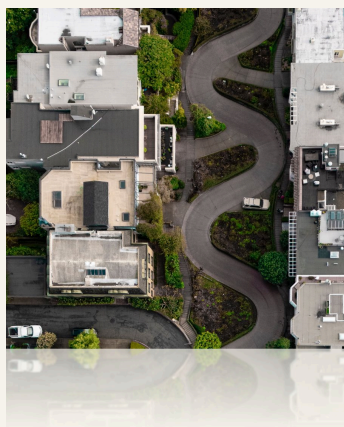
Romantic Group

SingleThread

Healdsburg

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group



Nightlife · 50 places

Dance clubs & nightlife

SoMa's warehouses, the Fillmore's posters, and Bimbo's since 1931.

SoMa's warehouses — Public Works, 1015, Audio — the Fillmore's posters, Bimbo's since 1931, and the free bluegrass festival in Golden Gate Park.

Why these Venues and clubs together. The Stud is on because it came back; Bob's Donuts because every night here ends there.

Public Works

Mission

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Great Northern

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Audio

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Halcyon

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

1015 Folsom

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Temple

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Monarch

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

F8

SoMa

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

DNA Lounge

SoMa; since 1985

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Cat Club

SoMa; 80s night

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Stud

SoMa; reborn

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Oasis

SoMa; drag

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Powerhouse

SoMa

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Eagle

SoMa

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

El Rio

Mission

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Make-Out Room

Mission

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Bissap Baobab

Mission; Senegalese dance nights

verify \$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Amado's

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Chapel

Mission

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Rickshaw Stop

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Independent

Divisadero

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Fillmore

Fillmore; the posters, the apples

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Bimbo's 365 Club

North Beach; since 1931

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Great American Music Hall

Tenderloin; 1907

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Warfield

Tenderloin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

August Hall

Union Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Bottom of the Hill

Potrero Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Thee Parkside

Potrero Hill

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Madrone Art Bar

Divisadero; Prince vs Michael

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Beaux

Castro

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Hi Tops

Castro

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Lookout

Castro

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Twin Peaks Tavern

Castro

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Aunt Charlie's

Tenderloin; drag

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Black Cat

Tenderloin; jazz

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Mr. Tipple's

Civic Center; jazz

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

SFJAZZ Center

Hayes Valley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Yoshi's

Oakland

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The New Parish

Oakland

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Fox Theater

Oakland

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Starline Social Club

Oakland

verify \$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Eli's Mile High Club

Oakland

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Bar Part Time

Mission; the record bar, late

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Key Klub late

Tenderloin

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Zeitgeist late

Mission

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Li Po late

Chinatown

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Bob's Donuts at 3am

Nob Hill

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Outside Lands

Golden Gate Park; August

\$\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Hardly Strictly Bluegrass

Golden Gate Park; October, free

\$ Walk-in

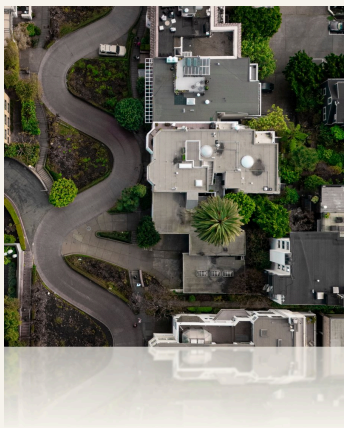
Late night Group

Portola Festival

Pier 80; September

\$\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group



Itineraries · for a first-time visitor

Just follow this.

Three ready-made food itineraries — one, three and five days — built only from places on this list, so a first-time visitor can eat well without doing the research.

Each plan runs on foot and by subway, one borough a day, with a big dinner every night and a backup for every table that's hard to get. Times are suggestions; the order matters more than the clock.

How to use it Book the starred dinners the morning reservations open, then walk everything else. The gotchas on the last page cover the rest: cash, tickets, tipping, dress codes, and the Amex credit.

Itinerary · One day

One day

North Beach to the Mission, on foot and one Muni ride. Focaccia at nine, a three-star at eight.

One day, mostly walkable if you like hills. Book one dinner. **Book one thing: dinner at Californios (Tock) — or Rintaro if the three-star is gone.**

The day

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 8:30 | Liguria Bakery (North Beach)
Focaccia, cash, wrapped in paper — go before ten or it's gone. Then a cappuccino at Caffè Trieste, where the West Coast's first espresso machine was installed in 1956. |
| <hr/> | |
| 10:00 | North Beach & Chinatown
City Lights, the alleys, the Golden Gate Fortune Cookie Factory in Ross Alley. Good Mong Kok for a bag of dim sum through the window. |
| <hr/> | |
| 12:00 | Swan Oyster Depot (Nob Hill)
The counter since 1912: crab Louie, a half-dozen oysters, sea urchin if they have it. Cash only; the line starts before eleven. Worth it. |
| <hr/> | |
| 2:00 | The Mission
Walk Valencia; Dandelion Chocolate for the factory; Bi-Rite Creamery for a scoop in Dolores Park. |
| <hr/> | |
| 4:00 | Trick Dog (Mission)
Whatever this season's menu is. Walk-in; go early. Then True Laurel next door — 50 Best. |
| <hr/> | |
| 6:00 | Zeitgeist (Mission)
One beer in the garden, because it's the city's living room. |
| <hr/> | |
| 8:00 | Californios (Mission) ★★★
Val Cantu's counter — the first three-star Mexican restaurant in the world, promoted in June. Tock, weeks out. Backup: Rintaro (izakaya, Bib, Resy), Flour + Water (Bib, Resy) or the Morris for the duck (Bib, Resy). |
| <hr/> | |
| 10:30 | Bar Part Time (Mission)
Records, natural wine, a dance floor that appears. Walk-in. |

Three days

The city, then the water, then the Richmond and the Sunset. Fog permitting.

A long weekend. Day one is the one-day plan; day two is the Embarcadero and Nob Hill; day three goes west to the ocean. **Book three dinners the day reservations open: Californios, Lazy Bear or Saison, and Mister Jiu's.**

Day 1 · North Beach to the Mission

All day **Follow the one-day plan**
Liguria, Chinatown, Swan, the Mission, Trick Dog, Zeitgeist, Californios, Bar Part Time.

Day 2 · The water & Nob Hill

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 8:30 | Ferry Building
Saturday market if it's Saturday; otherwise Blue Bottle, Acme bread, and Hog Island's oysters at the counter when it opens. |
| 11:00 | The Embarcadero
Walk south under the bridge; Red's Java House on Pier 30 for a burger on the pier if you're early-hungry. |
| 1:00 | Tadich Grill (FiDi)
California's oldest restaurant, 1849: cioppino or sand dabs at the counter. Walk-in; the wait is the ritual. Or Sam's Grill for the curtained booths. |
| 3:30 | Nob Hill
The cable car up California Street; the Tonga Room's rainstorm at the Fairmont for one mai tai; Bob's Donuts on the way down. |
| 5:30 | Top of the Mark or Big 4
The view, or the piano. Both walk-in early. |
| 7:30 | Lazy Bear (Mission) ★★ or Saison (SoMa) ★★
Lazy Bear for the dinner-party format (Tock); Saison for the hearth (Tock). Backup: Nisei ★ (Russian Hill; Tock) or Sons & Daughters ★ (Nob Hill; Tock). |
| 10:30 | Pacific Cocktail Haven (Union Square)
50 Best; walk-in late. Or Bourbon & Branch with the password. |

Day 3 • West

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 9:00 | Arsicault (Inner Richmond)
The croissant that won the country. Walk-in; the line moves. |
| 11:00 | Golden Gate Park
The de Young tower for the free view, the Japanese Tea Garden, then Andytown at the ocean for a Snowy Plover. |
| 1:00 | Outerlands (Outer Sunset)
Lunch a block from the beach. Or Hook Fish Co for a fish sandwich to eat on the dunes. |
| 3:30 | Tommy's Mexican (Outer Richmond)
Julio Bermejo's margarita — the one every bar copies — with a plate of tacos. Walk-in. |
| 5:30 | Chinatown
Li Po for a Chinese mai tai, Mr. Bing's for dice, Cold Drinks Bar upstairs at China Live if you want the good version. |
| 7:30 | Mister Jiu's (Chinatown) ★
Brandon Jew's Cantonese-Californian in the old Four Seas banquet hall. Resy, 30 days. Backup: Four Kings (his alumni, walk-in early) or Z & Y (Sichuan, Bib). |
| 10:00 | Moongate Lounge (upstairs)
The cocktail bar above Mister Jiu's. Then Vesuvio for a nightcap where the Beats drank. |

Five days

The three-day plan, plus a day across the bay and a day for Wine Country or the counters.

Enough time to leave the city: Berkeley and Oakland, Tomales Bay or Yountville, and the tasting counters that need weeks. **Set alarms for Californios, Benu or Atelier Crenn (Tock), and — if you're driving — the French Laundry.**

Days 1–3

All

Follow the three-day plan

North Beach and the Mission, the water and Nob Hill, the Richmond and the Sunset.

Day 4 · Across the bay

9:00

BART to Berkeley

Cheese Board Collective — one pizza a day, a line, a jazz trio — or Boichik for the bagel the Times called America's best.

11:30

Chez Panisse Café (Berkeley)

Upstairs, à la carte, Alice Waters' room since 1971. Resy; lunch is the accessible seat. Then Vik's Chaat if you're still hungry.

2:30

Oakland

Temescal: Bakesale Betty's fried chicken sandwich, Ordinaire for a glass. Grand Lake if it's Saturday, for the market.

5:00

Viridian or Bar Shiru (Oakland)

Asian-American cocktails, or the listening bar. Walk-in early.

7:30

Commis (Oakland) ★★ or Burdell (Oakland)

Commis for James Syhabout's counter (Tock); Burdell for Geoff Davis's Black Southern cooking, a James Beard finalist (Resy). Backup: Nyum Bai (Cambodian, Bib) or Snail Bar (wine, Bib).

10:00

The Kon-Tiki (Oakland)

Tiki, then BART home before midnight — check the schedule.

Day 5 • North, or the counters

- 9:00 **Drive north — Tomales Bay**
Hog Island Oyster Farm at Marshall: shuck your own on the picnic tables (reserve). The Marshall Store next door if you'd rather be served. Cash-friendly.
-
- 1:00 **Or: Yountville**
Bouchon Bakery for a macaron, Ad Hoc for fried chicken if it's Monday, La Calenda for Keller's Mexican (Bib). The French Laundry is a Tock ticket, two months out, and worth the effort once.
-
- 4:30 **Sausalito on the way back**
Fish. on the dock (cash), then the ferry into the city at sunset — the best \$14 view in the Bay.
-
- 6:30 **Charmaine's (SF Proper)**
One drink on the roof, Market Street below.
-
- 8:00 **Benu ★★★ or Atelier Crenn ★★★**
Benu for Corey Lee's Korean-inflected tasting (Tock); Atelier Crenn for Dominique Crenn's poem of a menu (Tock). Both weeks out. Alternative: Quince ★★★ (Tock) or Acquerello ★★ (Resy; the room since 1989).
-
- 11:00 **Bob's Donuts (Nob Hill)**
Open 24 hours. An apple fritter for the road.

Before you go.

The things New Yorkers know and visitors learn the expensive way.

Tock, Resy, and the two-month counters.

Benu, Atelier Crenn, Quince, Californios, Lazy Bear, Saison and the French Laundry sell tickets on Tock, often two months out and non-refundable. Resy runs the neighborhood rooms, 30 days out. Set alerts for both.

Cash at the institutions.

Swan Oyster Depot, Liguria, Saigon Sandwich, Fish. in Sausalito, Golden Gate Fortune Cookie and most of Chinatown's bakeries are cash-only or cash-first. Carry \$80 on the first day.

The fog is a neighborhood.

The Sunset and Richmond can be 15 degrees colder than the Mission on the same afternoon. Dress in layers; the Embarcadero is windier than it looks. 'Karl' is the fog's name and locals will use it.

Tip 20%; watch the SF Mandate line.

Many restaurants add a 5–6% 'SF Mandate' or health surcharge to cover city ordinances — it's not the tip, and it's legal. Sales tax on meals is 8.625%. Read the bill.

Hills, and how to move.

Muni and the cable cars take a contactless tap; BART to Oakland and Berkeley runs until about midnight. Rideshares are reliable but expensive at 2am. Nob Hill and Russian Hill are steeper than any map admits.

Monday is dark, and so is much of Sunday.

Most starred rooms close Sunday and Monday — Californios, Lazy Bear, Saison, Sons & Daughters all do. Chinatown, the Mission's taquerias and the Ferry Building run seven days.

The burrito rules.

A Mission burrito is foil-wrapped, rice and beans inside, and eaten standing. El Farolito and La Taqueria (no rice, and a Bib) are the two ends of the argument; order carne asada or al pastor at either and don't ask for a bowl.

Sourdough and the Irish coffee.

Boudin has baked the same mother dough since 1849; the bread bowl is for tourists but the loaf is real. The Buena Vista invented America's Irish coffee in 1952 and still makes 2,000 a day — the morning is the time.

Use the Amex credit like a local.

Platinum \$100 per quarter, Gold \$50 twice a year, at any Resy or Tock venue showing the 'Resy Credit eligible' badge. A prepaid Tock ticket at a three-star is the easiest use of it.

Anything marked verify, verify.

San Francisco lost Anchor Brewing, Liholiho, Aphotic, Bar Agricole, Mission Chinese and the Cliff House within a few years. A minute on Resy or Google before you climb a hill.

The Chinatown vocabulary.

Chinese mai tai (Li Po): rum, a secret mix, and a kick.
Dim sum to-go (Good Mong Kok): point, pay cash,
eat in Portsmouth Square. Salt-and-pepper crab
(R&G): the dish to order once.

One for the road.

SFO's International Terminal has a Boudin and a
Tartine; Terminal 2 has an Andale and, if you're
lucky, a Boichik. The BART ride from the city is the
cheapest way there and takes half an hour.

Notes

Michelin: the 2026 California selection, announced June 24, 2026 in San Diego. Californios in the Mission was promoted to three stars — the first Mexican restaurant in the world to hold them — joining Atelier Crenn, Benu and Quince in the city; Enclos in Sonoma also reached three, giving the Bay Area and Wine Country six three-star restaurants with the French Laundry and SingleThread. Restaurant Naides and Wolfsbane earned first stars in the city, Troubadour Bread & Bistro in Healdsburg; Kitchen Istanbul and Joodooboo joined the Bib list; Good Good Culture Club and Ippuku returned to it. California now counts 83 stars and 117 Bib Gourmands. The Progress, Kin Khao and Anchor Brewing are flagged because each changed shape since the last edition.

Bars: True Laurel (Nº17) and Pacific Cocktail Haven (Nº16) held 2025 North America's 50 Best rankings; their 2026 placings weren't confirmed for this edition.

Occasion chips for San Francisco are editorial assignments, by category and price. Tock and Resy split the counters; the Amex credit works at both.

Photography via Pexels (royalty-free): three photographs, cropped and reused across the twelve sections.

Honestly Speaking — the masthead these guides are published under — is also an independent, unsponsored restaurant review site. The full reviews, with the plate-first criticism the city guides don't have room for, live at honestlyspeaking.xyz. The city guides live at listedeville.com.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listedeville.com.